

David Fugate

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Engineering leader and consultant with 20+ years building scalable solutions for high-traffic media platforms and AI systems. Founder of a technology consulting practice serving major AI companies and traditional media organizations. Delivered 30% reliability improvements and 60% performance gains while managing 20-engineer teams across marquee publishing brands. Expertise spans machine learning implementations, data annotation, human-in-the-loop AI systems, and large-scale platform optimization serving millions of users.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Frontend: JavaScript/TypeScript, React, Next.js, Drupal, SASS, WCAG

Backend & Data: Node.js, PHP, RestAPI, MySQL, GraphQL, CI/CD

Media Production: Adobe Creative Suite, Video editing, Podcast production

AI/ML: Machine Learning, Data Pipeline Architecture, Model Implementation

EXPERIENCE

CompanyName.TV - Edina, MN

2005 – Present

Founder / Principal Consultant

- 20-year technology consulting practice serving media and AI companies
- Traditional media clients included NBC, Time Inc., CNN, NASCAR, Morris
- AI/ML clients included xAI, Invisible AI, Appen, Labelbox, and Snorkel AI
- Data annotation and ML model training for LLM development
- Human-in-the-loop AI evaluation and candidate assessment systems
- Specialized in scalable content platforms and ML model implementation for media and AI applications

Dow Jones - Minneapolis, MN

Feb 2023 – March 2025

Engineering Manager - Audio/Video, Content API

- **Increased data-delivery reliability by 30%** across WSJ and 3 other marquee brands through content-API enhancements
- **Managed a 20-engineer squad** delivering audio/video features and content APIs on schedule using agile methodologies
- **Eliminated deployment failures by 85%** through CI/CD workflows and automated testing protocols

Saks Inc. - New York, NY

May 2021 - Jan 2023

Team Lead, Chief Scrum Master

- **Improved site speed by 60%** and **increased checkout conversion 23%** through frontend optimization

- **Streamlined product discovery workflows**, reducing time-to-market for new features by 40%

Time Inc. - New York, NY

Feb 2013 - Apr 2021

Technical Lead, Senior Software Engineer & Scrum Master

- **Built a development framework** deployed across 40+ high-traffic entertainment sites, reaching 50M+ monthly users
- **Reduced content publishing time by 50%** through automated workflows and editorial team collaboration

Elephant Ventures - New York, NY

Jun 2014 - Aug 2015

Director of Technology

- Built consulting development team from 3 to 12 engineers, managing client relationships and technical requirements for concurrent engagements
- Implemented code review standards, reducing production bugs by 70%, delivering projects on time and under budget

COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

ht.live - Edina, MN

Jun 2017 - Present

Founder / Managing Director

- Founded a nonprofit media production studio and performing arts venue
- Developed media and content platforms for mental health initiatives and educational programming
- Over 200+ events produced and \$500K raised for community causes

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Scrum Alliance | 2014

- Certified Scrum Master (CSM)
- Certified Scrum Professional (CSP)

American Intercontinental University

- Communications; Film and Media Production